

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ A

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠ 5

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ 10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6
♥ J 10 9 5
♦ 9 7 2
♣ Q 10 7 4

♠ K Q 10 8 3

♥ K 6 2

♦ A K

♣ A K 6



♠ 9 4 2
♥ A Q 8 4
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ J 8

♠ A J 5

♥ 7 3

♦ 8 6 4 3

♣ 9 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♦ Q

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

It is possible (but not probable) that ♣s will split 3-3.

It is possible (one chance out of two) that West holds the ♥A. You could pull trumps, ending in dummy, then lead toward your ♥K.

It is almost certain that you could ruff your ♥ loser in dummy, but only if you play a ♥ at trick two, leading away from your ♥K. The defenders will win the ♥ cheaply and probably play a trump. You win dummy's ♠A and play another ♥ which they also win. They lead a second trump which you win in your hand. You now ruff the last ♥ with dummy's ♠J, return to your hand, pull trumps and claim.

You cannot be defeated if you play ♥s at the second trick.

If instead you decide to lead a ♠ to dummy's ♠J and lead a ♥ toward your ♥K you might go down. East could win the ♥A and play a second trump. When you played the next ♥ East would win again and play a third round of trumps. You would no longer be able to ruff the ♥ loser.

You have 23 points. You must open 2♣.

Partner responds 2♦ showing 7 or fewer points.

Following partner's negative response you merely bid your suit at the cheapest level.

You bid 2♠ and partner jumps to 4♠.

Now

Partner's first response told you he has a weak hand. It didn't suddenly turn into 10 or 11 points. Partner is merely pulling a "He Who Knows, Goes" bid. He thinks you belong in 4♠.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦Q.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦Q.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 10 4
 ♥ 10 6
 ♦ 7 5 3
 ♣ 10 8 6 4 3

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 8 6 4

♣ A K J

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A K Q J 9 7 5

♦ A K

♣ 7

♠ Q J 7

♥ 8 3

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ Q 9 5 2

West

North

East

South

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦ Q

through him to make the ♠ K a winner. That's a 50% possibility.

But you can improve on that a little bit. If South holds both the ♠ Q J you could make a deep finesse of dummy's ♠ 10 and North would have to play his ♠ A to win the trick. And if it didn't work and North won with a lesser ♠ you would still have time to play toward the ♠ K.

Win the ♦, pull trumps, lead the ♠ 3 to dummy's ♠ 10.

You can see that the deep finesse would indeed force North's ♠ A. However, South played his ♠ Q to the trick, forcing you to go up with dummy's ♠ K, which was taken by North's ♠ A.

You must modify the Plan a little bit. Now your only hope is that South still holds the ♠ J. So you win the next trick in your hand and lead a ♠ toward dummy's ♠ 10. This time South is caught. He plays the ♠ J hoping you had a doubleton, but you still have a ♠ to get to the now high ♠ 10.

One school of thought says to open 2♣ with a hand that is within one trick of game, even though the point count is below 22.

Another school of thought says to go ahead and bid the game, hoping to keep the opponents away from any competition.

Today you take the second and bid 4♥.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦ Q.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦ Q.

Losers: ♠ 3 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You are going to lose the ♣ for sure, so you need to find a way to hold the ♠ losers to 2. The obvious possibility is for South to hold the ♠ A and you lead

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 6 3

♥ 8 2

♦ J 10 9

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 8

♥ A 4

♦ A K 8 7 3

♣ A 10 9 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5 4 2

♥ K 7

♦ Q 5 4

♣ K J 7

♠ 9 7

♥ Q J 10 9 6 5 3

♦ 6 2

♣ Q 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

3♥

♦ K and then a small ♦ which you ruff. Now play your ♠ 9 and ruff with dummy's last trump.

Usually it is a good play to let a lead come up to your Queen. It's like a free finesse.

But you don't want to get into the habit of doing what is **USUALLY** good without thinking through the consequences.

You are very weak. But you are also not vulnerable.

So with 5 playing tricks you leap to 3♥. Partner raises to 4♥ and you pass.

South plays 4♥. West leads ♠ A, then ♥ 8.

South plays 4♥. West leads ♠ A, then ♥ 8.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You've already lost 1 ♠, you can't escape the ♣ and it looks like the ♥ is unavoidable also. So that means you can't afford to lose that second ♠.

If you play dummy's ♥ 4 East will win the ♥ K and play another ♥. You will lose that second ♠ and go down 1.

Instead you should rise with dummy's ♥ A, play ♦ A,

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 10
♥ 8 5 2
♦ A 7 4
♣ A K Q 9 8

♠ Q 9 7 5 3

♥ K 9

♦ 9 6 3

♣ J 10 4



♠ A J 6
♥ Q 7 3
♦ Q 8 5 2
♣ 7 6 2

♠ 8 4 2

♥ A J 10 6 4

♦ K J 10

♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠ 5			

♦ Q but even if it works they would probably attack ♥s. Your best chance of getting an extra trick lies in the ♠ suit.

It is almost certain that North holds the ♠Q. Of course defenders sometimes don't lead according to the guidelines, but if South had the ♠Q he would likely have played it at the first trick. In addition, the Rule of 11 tells you there were 6 cards in the East, South and West hands higher than the ♠5. You can account for all of them, so North must have the ♠Q. In that case you can assure the contract by winning the first trick with the ♠K rather than the ♠10. In this way you will be able to gain a trick by finessing North for the ♠Q. It's true that if you won with the ♠10 you would still have both the ♠K and ♠A remaining, but you wouldn't have the dummy entry you needed.

With the unfortunate placement of red cards the only way you can enjoy 3 ♠ tricks is to take your ♠K on the first trick and later finesse North for the ♠Q.

Notice how strange this game can be. If your holding was ♠ K 2 rather than ♠ K 10 you would have had no difficulty coming up with the correct play. But the fact that you can win a cheap trick with the ♠10 tries to lure you into making an inferior play.

With a balanced, 17 point hand you open 1NT. Partner responds 2NT.

You were invited to bid 3NT if you have a maximum opener. With 17 points you accept the invitation.

West plays 3NT. North leads ♠ 5. You put on dummy's ♠ 6 and South plays the ♠ 8.

West plays 3NT. North leads ♠ 5. You put on dummy's ♠ 6 and South plays the ♠ 8.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 5 : Total = 8

The good news is that they didn't lead a ♥. The bad news is that if you give up the lead they probably will.

Assuming the ♣s behave you need to get one more winner. It's possible you could lead toward dummy's

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ 10 9
 ♦ A K J 7 3
 ♣ Q 10 6 2

♠ A K Q 5 3

♥ A Q 7 3

♦ 5 4

♣ A 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 2
 ♥ J 8 5 4
 ♦ 10 9 8
 ♣ K 9 4

♠ 9 6 4

♥ K 6 2

♦ Q 6 2

♣ J 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ 10			

You have a nice hand, but can only open 1 ♠.

Partner raises to 2 ♠.

Partner has 6-10 points, you have 20 points.

The math works so you bid 4 ♠.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 10, you cover and West plays the three high ♦ s.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 10, you cover and West plays the three high ♦ s.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

To start with, you ruff the third ♦. You cannot avoid the ♣ loser, so you might think that ♥ s must break evenly to give you a fourth ♥ trick. In fact, there is a chance that you might ruff the fourth ♥.

Play exactly two rounds of trumps with the ♠ A and ♠ K. Then play ♥ K, ♥ A and ♥ Q. If both defenders follow to three leads your fourth ♥ is good so you pull the last trump. If somebody shows out on the third lead and does not ruff then play your last ♥ and ruff in dummy. Return to your hand with the ♣ A and pull trumps.

You will always make the contract when ♥ s split 3-3.

By pulling exactly 2 rounds of trumps first you can also succeed in the case where ♥ s split 4-2 and the defender with the doubleton ♥ also has a doubleton trump.